He responded by first calling those who said they hadn't got anything on stage. He asked them one-by-one to list what they didn't get. Then he called the CDO there with the beneficiary lists. He questioned one of the complainants, are you under the poverty line? He said no. Yogiji said, how will you get it if you are above the poverty line? Then he asked one who was saying he hadn't got a house if he already had a house. He said yes, but it is old. Yogiji said, don't you know only those people get houses who don't have a pucca one. Many people still kept complaining, so Yogiji read out the lists—how many people have got what. As the names were being read out, and the villagers heard the names, the people's attitude changed. They realised that things had been received. As names were read, he would say whose name is this, stand up. Slowly but surely, the disturbance and perception changed. We realised that day that the person who gets something mostly remains quiet. This is how we changed the narrative.

Yogi Adityanath's chaupals were a logical extension of a booth-level initiative of direct mobilisation around welfare schemes that the BJP's UP unit started in 2016. 'Labharthee sammelan' is a term that comes up a lot when you speak to the state's BJP leaders. Deputy Chief Minister Dinesh Sharma explained that these beneficiary meetings were systematically organised around specific schemes in each booth area. 'For this, we did labharthee sammelans,' he said. 'Someone got a gas chulha, someone got a toilet. We did separate sammelans with those who got gas cylinders and separate sammelans with those who got toilets. We did these kinds of activities at the booth level.'[24] The first aim of these meetings was to hammer home the political linkage of these schemes with Modi. 'Our opponents can shout as much as they like,' says Sharma. 'Labharthees know that these toilets got made by Modiji. They know that the Kisan Samman Rashi is theirs, which Modiji gave them. This is unlike before. There was a saying that do a good deed and put it in the well. Now it is, do a good deed and put it to the people, in the people's darbar. That is what we did with these sammelans.'

Furthermore, these labharthee sammelans also served as a second layer of checks and balances on welfare schemes outside of